Aluwind Infra-Tech Ltd. (NSE Emerge: ALUWIND) — Company Dossier — Masterclass Companion Book

A step-by-step narrative walkthrough and audio companion to Aluwind Infra-Tech Ltd. (NSE Emerge: ALUWIND) – Company Dossier: deconstructing the business engine, global historical parallels, ten-year financial forensics, both sides of the institutional debate, and the discipline of high-asymmetry execution.

Company & Market: Aluwind Infra-Tech Ltd. (NSE Emerge: ALUWIND) — Company Dossier (IN)
Research Session Cutoff: 2026-11-13 • **Generated:** 13 Nov 2026, 05:41 PM PST
Core Verdict: WAIT_FOR_SUPPORT
Authored & Narrated by: Senior Institutional Equity Research Desk • Masterclass Companion Audio-Reader Edition (15,886 words • ~102 min listen)

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SESSION PRICE

NEW CAPITAL VERDICT

`WAIT_FOR_SUPPORT`

CURRENT HOLDING ACTION

`NOT HELD – NOT HELD (0 shares); no current holding to trim or exit.`

STAGE POSTURE

VALUATION WATCH ZONE (CONDITIONAL)

`₹40.00–42.00`

18-MONTH SCENARIO RANGE

Bear ₹27.00 / Base ₹56.00 / Bull ₹84.00

PREFACE & CORE THESIS

Aluwind Infra-Tech makes and installs aluminium windows and facades from one Pune plant, and FY26 revenue of ₹138.6 Cr is six times FY21. Profit is audited, but operating cash flow was negative for three years (₹-37.5 Cr against ₹26.1 Cr of profit) and borrowings rose to ₹46 Cr. Our call for new capital is WAIT_FOR_SUPPORT: accumulate only at ₹40.00 to ₹42.00, invalidate on a weekly close below ₹36.95, base value ₹56 against a ₹44.90 close. The chart is Stage 4 and the stock trades about 9,650 shares a day, while the ledger shows no ALUWIND shares, so nothing is held or to be sold. The call turns on Eternia's December 2026 renewal and on H2 FY27 operating cash flow reaching about ₹5 Cr.

PROLOGUE

The Business, The Price & Our Independent Verdict

> *""We remain committed to operational excellence, working capital optimization and executing projects timely.""*
>
> — M.M. KABRA, MANAGING DIRECTOR, ALUWIND INFRA-TECH, PRESS RELEASE ON FY26 RESULTS, 5 MAY 2026

Before we go any further, let me tell you what this company is and what I think of it.

Aluwind makes and installs the aluminium-and-glass skin of buildings: windows, doors, curtain walls and facades. Its customers are developers and big contractors, among them Larsen and Toubro, Godrej, Runwal and Vascon. The work is made to order at one plant near Pune and a single project can take one to three years. The company listed in April 2024 at ₹45, and last year it sold ₹138.6 Cr of work and earned ₹10.5 Cr after tax .

Here is what it does well. Revenue is about six and a half times what it was in FY21. Margins have held at 11% to 14%. The auditor gave a clean opinion, and the IPO money went where the prospectus said it would. If you only read the profit and loss account, you would call it a small success story .

Here is what it has not done. It has not turned that profit into cash. Across FY24, FY25 and FY26 the company earned ₹26 Cr and its operations absorbed ₹37.5 Cr, because the money was tied up in inventory, in bills customers had not paid, in retention money held back until a job is finished, and in work done but not yet billed. Banks filled the gap, and borrowings went from ₹13 Cr to ₹46 Cr in a year and a half. That is the thread I want you to hold through every chapter that follows .

My verdict on the business is cyclical and conditional. I do not call it a failure, because profit, margins and audit quality hold, and in the half-year to September 2026 operations finally returned a small positive cash flow of ₹0.8 Cr. I do not call it a compounder, because each extra rupee of capital added since FY24 has earned about 5% to 6.5%, less than the company pays its lenders. And I give the ₹200 Cr revenue target for this year a probability of 10% or less. I think ₹150 Cr to ₹170 Cr is more likely .

Now the price. At the 13 November close of ₹44.90 the whole company was worth about ₹110.6 Cr, nine times profit and one and a half times book value, and the stock sat exactly at its IPO price after halving from its autumn 2025 high. At that price the market needs profit to grow about 12% a year if the owners can take home 80% of it in cash, and about 20% a year if they can take home only 60%. The chart is in a downtrend, and the shares trade only about 9,650 a day .

So my call for new money is to wait, and to wait at a price. I would look at ₹40.00 to ₹42.00, and I would give up on the idea if the share closes a week below ₹36.95. My base value is ₹56, which is about 25% above the last close. In the good case it is ₹84, and in the bad case ₹27. If I weight the three by 45%, 20% and 35%, I get about ₹51, only 14% above the close, which does not pay me enough for the risk in a stock this thin. At the last close the reward for each rupee of risk is 1.4. At the top of my zone it is 2.8, and only entries near ₹40.50 or lower clear a 17% annual hurdle.

What about your own holding? The ledger shows none, so there is nothing to sell. For the next unit of cash I would keep all of it in cash. Ajmera Realty and Manorama Industries pass the technical gate but sit above their own entry zones with conflicting stage readings, so I fund neither, and I put nothing into Aluwind yet. If you do buy Aluwind later, size it to liquidity and not to conviction: about 1,000 shares, or ₹45,000, at most, and a third of that before the second-half results. All of this is guidance, not an instruction to a broker.

Three dated events will tell us whether the wait is over. The Eternia agreement, which gives Aluwind preferred status for Hindalco's window brand in the Mumbai region, comes up for renewal in December 2026. The results for the second half of FY27, around May 2027, should show operating cash flow of about ₹5 Cr and borrowings below ₹60 Cr. And the share price has to hold its ₹40 floor or climb back above the 30-week average. Keep those three in your head, and read on to see how I got here .

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
>
> Management says it is committed to working-capital optimization. That is the right promise, and it is the one the cash-flow statement has not yet kept. Everything in this dossier is a way of asking whether the next two statements will keep it.

CHAPTER I

How the Business & Stock Got Here — Past Cycles & Pivots

> ""*What began in 2003 as a small fabrication firm in Santacruz, Mumbai, has today grown into one of India's trusted names in façade and fenestration solutions.*""
>
> — MURLI MANOHAR KABRA, CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING DIRECTOR, ANNUAL REPORT FY2025-26

Let me tell you how I read a company's past, and then we will do it together for Aluwind.

I do not start with the share-sale prospectus or the press release. I start with the question: what did this business look like when nobody was watching? For Aluwind, the answer is a small family fabrication shop in Santacruz, Mumbai, opened in April 2003 when two Kabra brothers took over a partnership called Alu-Wind Industries . A third brother later ran the factory. Their sons now sit in the technology and marketing chairs . It is a family business that learned to work with developers, and it is still run that way.

Two words before we go further. Fenestration is simply windows and doors. A façade is the outer skin of a large building, the glass-and-aluminium wall you see on an office tower. Aluwind began with the first and has been moving, order by order, toward the second.

For seventeen years the company was small. Revenue was ₹21.28 Cr in FY21 and ₹28.99 Cr in FY22, and profit was under ₹1 Cr both years . There were landmarks. About ₹21 Cr of work for Vascon Engineers between 2007 and 2009 . A ₹7 Cr job in Hyderabad in 2013 . A first order from L&T Realty in 2015 that grew into about ₹65 Cr of L&T work by 2022 . But if you had asked an analyst in 2019 to name the company's edge, the honest answer would have been: relationships and reliability, not scale.

Then came June 2020 and a deal with Eternia, the premium window brand of Hindalco, part of the Aditya Birla Group. Aluwind became an exclusive fabricator, which means it built and installed windows using Eternia's aluminium sections and design system. Look at what happened next. Eternia projects were ₹0.57 Cr of sales in FY21, 2.67% of the total. By FY23 they were ₹25.28 Cr, 51.74%, and Hindalco supplied 44% of everything Aluwind bought

that year . I would call that the company's first real cycle: a partnership turned a ₹21 Cr firm into a ₹49 Cr firm in two years.

Now ask yourself the question I always ask at this point: what is the catch? The catch is a date. The anchor-partner agreement, which names Aluwind as Eternia's lead partner in the Mumbai region, was renewed in December 2023 for three years . It falls due in December 2026, a few weeks after our research cutoff. I could not find any public record of its renewal terms. That is not a red flag. It is a gap, and I want you to carry it into the chapters ahead.

The listing came next. The company turned public in October 2023, issued bonus shares, and sold 66,00,000 fresh shares at a fixed ₹45 each in a ₹29.70 Cr issue, led by Corpwis Advisors with NNM Securities as market maker . It was subscribed 8.19 times . The promoters went from 98.22% to 72.13% . The prospectus said the money would fund ₹20.45 Cr of working capital and ₹6.5 Cr of general corporate needs . I checked the record. The statement filed in May 2025 shows ₹20.45 Cr used for working capital and ₹6.49 Cr for general purposes, with just ₹5.67 lakh left over, and the auditor's certificate of November 2025 confirms full use . So here is a company that spent IPO money as it said it would. Look at the register today: promoters hold 72.61%, institutions 1.17%, and 945 shareholders in all . It is a closely held company with a thin public float.

But there is a second question: did it work? The prospectus assumed inventory would fall to 72 days of material cost, customers would pay in about 114 days and suppliers would be paid in 27 to 29 days, a cycle of about 157 days . The filed ratios for FY26 imply about 167 days of inventory, 90 days of receivables and 118 days of payables, a cycle near 139 days . Customers paid faster than planned. But stock is far higher than planned, and suppliers are funding the business for four months, not one. On the Screener basis the cycle is even longer, 181 days. Chapter 3 explains why.

Let me walk you through the second cycle. FY24 was the peak: revenue ₹83.43 Cr, EBITDA margin about 14.2%, profit ₹7.54 Cr . Then FY25 revenue rose 31% to ₹109.22 Cr but EBITDA grew just 1.5% . Think about that for a moment. The company sold 31% more and earned 1.5% more operating profit. The margin dropped from 14.2% to 11.0%. The filings do not give a margin by product, so this is my reading: larger façade jobs, more factory and site labour (₹15.0 Cr in FY25, ₹23.3 Cr in FY26) and more rent all arrived before the scale

benefits did . And the cash? Operating cash flow was negative in FY25 and again in FY26, at about ₹18.8 Cr and ₹16.3 Cr . Profit was real, but it went into stock and receivables.

Capacity followed the orders. The factory covered 45,000 sq ft at the time of the prospectus, with utilisation of 17%, 24% and 41% over FY21 to FY23 . (Utilisation here means the share of rated cutting-and-fabrication capacity actually used.) A second 44,000 sq ft building was leased in October 2024 . By June 2025 the company reported 18,600 m² a month at 50% utilisation, and a new computer-controlled cutting line added 3,162 m² a month for ₹3.90 Cr . In FY26 it also signed a toll agreement with Hindalco, which lets Eternia's West and South India window orders use Aluwind's idle capacity, and it booked ₹1.57 Cr from that . Notice what this says: the company expanded capacity at half utilisation. That is a bet on façade orders.

A name change came in April 2025, from Aluwind Architectural to Aluwind Infra-Tech, with the board citing broader work in infrastructure and technology . A subsidiary for façade cleaning, Aluwind Clean-Tech, was formed a month later. The annual report calls it wholly owned in one place and 60% owned in another; the disclosure table says 60% . It had no revenue in FY26 and lost ₹7.46 lakh, and it lost another ₹8.9 lakh in H1 FY27 . It is small enough to ignore financially, and it is a reminder to read the footnotes.

Where does that leave us today? Borrowings went from ₹13.1 Cr to ₹41.3 Cr between March 2025 and March 2026, and to ₹46.1 Cr by September 2026 . The order book has hovered around ₹300 Cr for eighteen months: ₹302 Cr in May 2025, ₹315 Cr in November 2025, ₹300 Cr in May 2026 . Management says FY27 revenue will reach ₹200 Cr. The first half gave ₹74.0 Cr, so the second half must give ₹126 Cr, which is 72% more than the last second half . In earlier years the second half beat the first, but never by that much. I would put the chance at 10% or less.

You may be wondering what the share price did while all this was happening. It listed at the ₹45 issue price in April 2024. It climbed to a month-end close of ₹90.9 by October 2025, after a string of L&T and Vascon orders. It has since slid about 51% to ₹44.9, which is where it started. The profit line rose through all of it. The shares fell because the cash-flow statement and the borrowing line told a harder story than the income statement did. We will come back to what that means for the price in Chapter 7 .

One more thing you should know. In 2026 the company lost its CFO and its company secretary and hired replacements, and on 5 November 2026 it appointed Ajay Porwal, founder of the Alphatech Group, to explore exports . It has no export revenue today. Change at the top is not bad news in itself, but a company that is growing fast on borrowed working capital needs steady hands in finance. We will see how that plays out. First, though, we need to understand what Aluwind actually sells, which is where we go next.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
>
> Aluwind's history is a story of three cycles, and each one began with a partner and ended with a cash question. The Eternia tie-up lifted sales; the façade push lifted order size; the cost of both was paid in inventory and unpaid bills. When you read the next chapters, keep one test in mind: does each rupee of new revenue arrive with a rupee of new cash, or with a bank loan?

CHAPTER II

Inside Every Segment — Products, Customers & Real-World Examples

> ""*Going forward, the contribution of facades will increase gradually leading to better execution and margin profiles for the company.*""
>
> — ALUWIND INFRA-TECH, FY26 RESULTS PRESS RELEASE, 5 MAY 2026

Let me ask you to picture three places, because that is the fastest way to understand what Aluwind does. First, a half-finished residential tower in Kandivali, Mumbai. Second, a glass office campus going up in Chennai. Third, a factory shed on the Pune-Aurangabad highway. Aluwind is the company that connects the three: it makes things in the third place and hangs them on the first two.

Before we go further, a warning about what the accounts do and do not tell you. The annual report splits revenue into only two lines: aluminium windows and façade work, ₹136.99 Cr in FY26, and tolling, ₹1.57 Cr . The half-year filing says the company has a single reportable segment, because tolling is below 10% of revenue . So there is no official figure for how much of the ₹138.56 Cr came from windows and how much from façades. When you read a number online claiming to give that split, it is an estimate. I will tell you where I am estimating and where the company has actually told us.

Start with the tower. Godrej Properties is building Towers 3, 4 and 5 of Godrej Reserve. It needs aluminium windows, deck railings, glazing and louvers for hundreds of homes. On 16 January 2026 it gave Aluwind the job for ₹43.15 Cr excluding GST, to be completed within 38 months . Think about what that means. The work will run into 2029. Each month Aluwind will deliver about ₹1.14 Cr of it, on average. The company's own description of its process is simple. Designers draw the windows. Consultants check the drawings. Aluminium is bought, painted in a powder-coating line, cut and machined by computer-controlled equipment, assembled, loaded on Aluwind's own trucks and fitted by labour hired for the site . The price is fixed in the contract and the revenue is booked as work is done .

Windows are the older half of the business. They come in two flavours. A plain system window is made to a standard design. An Eternia window uses the Hindalco brand's

aluminium range, and Aluwind is the lead partner for Mumbai. Tata Realty ordered Eternia windows for its Tata Serein building in Thane for ₹7.5 Cr . Capacit'e Infraprojects ordered them for a Worli redevelopment for ₹8.74 Cr . The largest window award of all is Runwal Realty's ₹89.9 Cr, announced in October 2024: windows for 19 towers, about 14.5 lakh sq ft, across Mumbai, Thane and Pune, with some façade work, to be done over three years . Divide the value by the area and you get at most about ₹620 per sq ft. The older Birla Vanya job works out near ₹1,100 per sq ft (₹22 Cr for about 2,00,000 sq ft) . Do not treat either as a price list; the windows differ in grade, and the Runwal figure includes façade.

Last July the company took on a different type of window job: Lodha's Bhandup project, ₹12.59 Cr, written as full material plus labour on an item-rate basis . Item rate means Aluwind is paid a set rate for each measured unit, not one lump sum. That puts quantity risk on the customer and price risk on Aluwind.

There is a smaller version of the window order too. Godrej Projects Development gave Aluwind an order for what the industry calls SITC: supply, installation, testing and commissioning of aluminium windows and railings for Godrej Gardens in Mumbai. The value was ₹7.60 Cr and the deadline 24 months from acceptance . That is just ₹0.32 Cr of revenue a month. A job like this keeps a crew and a section of the factory busy for two years without ever becoming large, which is why management prefers to talk about façades.

You can see the older, finished versions of this work in the company's own report. The Gigaplex project for K Raheja in Airoli, Mumbai, is described as a façade of 85,000 square feet. The Birla Vanya housing project took system windows over 2,00,000 square feet . Both are the sort of reference a developer will ask to see before it lets a contractor bid. They also tell you something about scale: this is a company that has fitted windows on a few hundred thousand square feet of towers, not one that has built a skyline.

Now the Chennai campus. A façade is the glass-and-aluminium skin of a commercial building. Aluwind makes a type called unitised: instead of fitting glass piece by piece on site, the company builds whole storey-high panels in the factory, ships them and a crane lifts them into place. At the L&T Innovation Campus in Powai, Mumbai, the panels are 1.5 m by 4.2 m . That job was the largest façade order the company had ever received from L&T Construction, and Eternia's own project page lists the campus at 36,000 square metres . I

could not find what L&T paid. But I can tell you about another campus where the price is known. Vascon Engineers awarded the façade for the Capgemini campus at Siruseri, Chennai, for ₹43.03 Cr, to be finished in 18 months . That is about ₹2.39 Cr of revenue every month, more than twice the monthly pace of the Godrej windows. Eternia's page lists a 12,200 square-metre Capgemini campus façade in Chennai . If that is the same scope, the price is near ₹35,000 per square metre. The filing does not confirm it, so treat that as a clue and not a fact.

Between the tower and the campus sits a third group: cladding, skylights, canopies, railings and the stainless-steel point-fixed glass called spider glazing . Examples are small and varied. A second skin for the Mumbai cruise terminal, ₹15.4 Cr in six months . Façade and aluminium work for the Sabarmati depot of the Mumbai-Ahmedabad bullet train, ₹15.61 Cr . A façade for AIIMS Madurai, ₹19.21 Cr . A façade package for the Navi Mumbai airport's ancillary buildings, ₹6.23 Cr in 3.5 months . A clubhouse and entrance lobby at Prestige City in Mulund, ₹8.30 Cr . Add up the fifteen orders in the table and you get ₹322.55 Cr. By my reading, about 44% is façade and 56% is windows. L&T entities account for about 24%; Maharashtra is 65% of the value, Tamil Nadu 30% and Gujarat 5%. These are my counts from announcements, not company ratios.

Who actually pays? There are three kinds of customer. Residential developers such as Godrej, Runwal, Lodha, Tata Realty and Prestige buy windows. Contractors and corporate owners such as L&T and Vascon, acting for a campus, buy façades. Institutions and public infrastructure, including AIIMS, the bullet train, an airport and a cruise terminal, buy a bit of both . Concentration is the question to ask here. The prospectus showed the top ten customers at 67% of FY23 sales and 59% of the first half of FY24, with L&T group entities about 19% in FY23 . The FY26 report does not give a customer table. From the announcements alone, L&T entities hold about 24% of disclosed order value. Treat that as a sign that concentration is still high.

Two newer lines deserve a short mention. Tolling means making another company's product in your factory for a fee. Aluwind signed a toll agreement with Hindalco in FY26 to build window orders for Eternia's West and South India retail business, and it earned ₹1.57 Cr, 1.1% of revenue . The pricing is not disclosed. In a typical toll deal the customer supplies the

metal and you earn a conversion fee, so there is less cash tied up. That is my understanding, not a stated term. The second line is the subsidiary Aluwind Clean-Tech, which plans to clean and maintain façades, including by drone . It has earned nothing and lost money in FY26 and H1 FY27 . No client is named. If you are looking for a worked example of Clean-Tech, I have to tell you there isn't one yet.

What about the order book? Management puts it at about ₹300 Cr, as of May 2026, which is 2.2 times last year's revenue . The phrase "order book" simply means signed work not yet billed. The useful test is how fast it turns into revenue. In the first half of FY27 the company billed ₹73.99 Cr, or about ₹12.3 Cr a month . At that pace, ₹300 Cr is about 24 months of work. The disclosed orders run from 3.5 months (the airport package) to 38 months (Godrej Reserve), so the book is a mix of fast façade jobs and long window programmes. Management's FY27 target of ₹200 Cr would need ₹16.7 Cr a month for the full year, which is why the façade share matters so much .

Now compare windows and façades the way a practitioner would. Look at the billing speed. A window order bills slowly over two or three years. A façade order bills two to four times faster per month. Godrej Reserve runs at ₹1.14 Cr a month, Lodha at ₹0.55 Cr, Godrej Gardens at ₹0.32 Cr. Capgemini runs at ₹2.39 Cr and the cruise terminal at ₹2.57 Cr. That is why management says façades will lift execution. A faster order uses the factory better and is finished sooner. But there is a price. A façade needs material bought early, panels built before they are hung, and a bank guarantee to bid. Customers hold back a slice of every bill, called retention, until the defect period ends. At March 2026 the customers were holding ₹13.68 Cr of Aluwind's money, while Aluwind held back only ₹1.69 Cr from its own vendors .

So what does the line "the contribution of facades will increase" mean for you? Margins first. The half-year to September 2026 showed an EBITDA margin of 13.4%, against 12.3% a year earlier, by my calculation . That supports management. Cash next. Over the same six months billed receivables rose from ₹39.05 Cr to ₹54.70 Cr . That does not. My view is that the façade mix probably adds one to two points of margin over two years, with a chance of about 55%, and that it will almost certainly demand more working capital first. The ₹300 Cr order

book, about 2.2 times last year's revenue, is real cover . It only becomes cash if customers pay, which is where we go next.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
>
> A contractor's business is the shape of its orders. Aluwind's orders are bigger, shorter and more geographically spread than they were two years ago, and each of those changes raises both the potential margin and the cash tied up in every job. When a company tells you its mix is improving, ask what the improvement costs in working capital, and look for the receivables line before you believe the margin line.

CHAPTER III

How It Is Sold & Delivered — Distribution & Unit Economics

> *""“Extended Payment Cycles from Developers: Cash strapped real estate developers might extend payment cycles which further can impact procurement and fabrication.”"*
>
> — ALUWIND INFRA-TECH, ANNUAL REPORT FY2025-26, MANAGEMENT DISCUSSION AND ANALYSIS (THREATS)

Walk with me for a moment to a shed at Gat 374 on the Pune-Aurangabad highway at Koregaon Bhima. Aluminium sections arrive in bundles, many of them from Hindalco, the maker of Eternia . In one corner a seven-tank pretreatment line cleans them before a powder-coating booth and oven paint them . In another, computer-controlled cutters and a new Italian five-axis machine cut and machine each profile with the precision a window or a unitised panel demands . Finished frames are loaded on the company’s own vehicles and driven to a tower in Mumbai or a campus in Chennai. That is the whole physical business. The shed is not where the hard part is.

The hard part is how an order gets there. Aluwind does not sell from a shelf. A developer or contractor floats a tender, an architect or consultant has often already been briefed, and Aluwind bids. The prospectus is candid about the rules. Clients shortlist bidders on net worth, experience, capacity and bonding, but then, in the company’s own words, “price competitiveness of the bid is the most important selection criterion” . Many orders come back from clients it has served before; management speaks of an 80% repeat rate . That matters because it means relationships get Aluwind onto the list, and price decides the winner.

There are four routes. For façades, the company usually works as a subcontractor to a main contractor such as L&T Construction or Vascon Engineers. For windows, it often deals directly with developers such as Godrej, Runwal, Lodha and Tata Realty. The third route is Eternia, the Hindalco window brand: Aluwind is its lead partner in the Mumbai region, and that agreement comes up for renewal in December 2026 . The fourth is a new toll arrangement, under which Aluwind builds Eternia’s retail window orders for a fee . It earned

₹1.57 Cr from that in FY26. Look at what is common to the first three: Aluwind does not set the price and does not set the payment terms.

Now follow the money. The raw materials are glass, aluminium sections, panels, steel, sealants, gaskets and hardware . There are no long-term supply contracts; most is bought on the spot market . The prospectus says contracts usually allow for cost escalation and that the company recovers price rises from customers, yet the FY26 accounting policy says contracts are fixed price, and the company itself lists aluminium volatility among its threats . If there is an aluminium price-variation clause, it is not disclosed. Until I see one, I assume Aluwind carries a good part of the metal-price risk between the day it bids and the day it buys.

Capacity first, then people. In June 2025 the company stated 18,600 m² a month at 50% utilisation and added 3,162 m² a month with a ₹3.90 Cr CNC line . Rated capacity is therefore about 21,762 m² a month, or roughly 261,000 m² a year, against 65,378 m² produced in FY23 . It has not said how full the plant is today. The staff has grown from 178 permanent employees in 2023 to over 500 in March 2026, and site crews come through labour contractors . Labour and factory cost rose from 13.7% of sales to 16.8% in a year . Plant and machinery is small, with a net block of ₹9.59 Cr against sales of ₹138.56 Cr. So the money in this business is not in the shed. It is in the stock and the unpaid bills.

The contract terms decide when the cash arrives. Revenue is booked as work progresses, by comparing cost incurred with estimated total cost . Customers keep back a slice of every bill as retention until the defect period ends. The contractor usually has to furnish a performance bank guarantee, which a customer can call if the work fails, and pays liquidated damages if it is late . None of the billing schedules is disclosed. What is disclosed is the result: ₹32.75 Cr of unbilled work, ₹13.68 Cr of retention and ₹25.37 Cr of ordinary receivables at March 2026 .

Let me show you where each ₹100 of FY26 revenue went, using the audited consolidated accounts. Materials and stock changes took ₹69.98. Employees took ₹12.29. Other expenses took ₹5.90. That leaves an EBITDA of ₹11.83, or ₹16.39 Cr. Depreciation took ₹1.26, interest ₹1.56 and tax ₹2.58, while other income added ₹1.11. Profit after tax was ₹7.54, or ₹10.45 Cr . If the story ended there, you would call it a decent business. It does not end there.

Because the second page of the accounts, the cash flow statement, says that the operating cash flow was minus ₹16.33 Cr . Let me be precise about what that number is. It is the audited consolidated net cash flow from operating activities, after ₹3.23 Cr of tax paid and before ₹2.16 Cr of interest, which the company reports under financing. Before working capital the business generated ₹16.93 Cr. Then it spent ₹30.04 Cr on working capital. Inventory took ₹27.02 Cr. Customers and unbilled work took ₹16.13 Cr. Customer advances and other liabilities fell by ₹3.69 Cr. Suppliers lent ₹14.36 Cr to help, and vendor advances and other items returned a net ₹2.44 Cr. The result: minus ₹13.11 Cr from operations, and minus ₹16.33 Cr after tax. Per ₹100 of sales, that is a cash loss of ₹11.79. After ₹4.47 Cr of capital spending, free cash flow was minus ₹20.80 Cr, minus ₹15.01 per ₹100. (The standalone figure is –₹16.31 Cr, and the H1 FY27 filing shows the FY26 comparative as –₹16.32 Cr. I use the audited consolidated number.)

Why did it happen? Think of a contractor who must buy aluminium and glass, build the panels, and hang them, before the customer's final cheque. Inventory grew 88%, from ₹30.54 Cr to ₹57.56 Cr, while revenue grew 27%. Stores and spares alone went from ₹5.05 Cr to ₹13.81 Cr, and the filing does not say what is in that bucket . Customers held ₹13.68 Cr of retention, up from ₹9.82 Cr, while Aluwind held back only ₹1.69 Cr from its own vendors . Advances from customers fell from ₹9.50 Cr to ₹5.78 Cr, so the customers funded less of the work . Billed receivables, retention and unbilled work together were ₹71.80 Cr, 52% of revenue . A growing contractor eats cash even while earning profit, unless customers pay in advance or suppliers lend.

Suppliers did lend. Trade payables rose from ₹25.71 Cr to ₹40.07 Cr, of which ₹7.49 Cr is covered by bank letters of credit . And the banks lent too: borrowings went from ₹13.09 Cr to ₹41.32 Cr, through cash credit lines of ₹10 Cr and ₹15 Cr, a ₹10 Cr working-capital loan and ₹9.11 Cr of unsecured bank and NBFC money, with the cash-credit lines backed by personal guarantees from the Kabra brothers . About ₹12.64 Cr of deposits sit under bank lien, so part of what was borrowed is parked as security .

Let me put the promise and the outcome next to each other, as I did in Chapter 1. The prospectus planned for debtors of 114 days, inventory of 72 days and suppliers paid in 29 days, a cycle of about 157 days . The filings show debtor days of 103 on one basis and 90 on

another, better than planned. Inventory days of 258 or 167 are far worse than planned. Payable days of 180 or 118 are far longer than planned. On the Screener basis the full cycle went from 126 to 181 days in one year . On the company's own turnover ratios it is about 139 days . Pick either basis: the cash is trapped for four to six months, and suppliers are carrying more of it than the company said they would.

H1 FY27 offers a first sign of change and a warning. Operating cash flow turned slightly positive at ₹0.81 Cr, because inventory fell ₹6.18 Cr . But billed receivables rose by ₹15.65 Cr to ₹54.70 Cr, supplier credit fell by ₹3.50 Cr and borrowings reached ₹46.06 Cr . I would give about a 35% chance that FY27 operating cash flow ends clearly positive, above ₹5 Cr. It needs receivables to flatten just as the second-half revenue ramp arrives. The risks that follow are the subject of the next chapter.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
>
> Aluwind's plant is small and its margins are fine; its problem is the clock. Every rupee of new revenue has to be financed for about four to six months by stock, unbilled work and withheld retention, and the funding so far has come from suppliers and banks. Do not judge a contractor by what it earns on a job. Judge it by when the last rupee of that job reaches the bank.

CHAPTER IV

The Battlefield — Rivals, Switching Costs & Moat Reality

> *""“Cash strapped real estate developers might extend payment cycles which further can impact procurement and fabrication.”"*
>
> — ALUWIND INFRA-TECH LTD., ANNUAL REPORT FY2025-26, MANAGEMENT DISCUSSION AND ANALYSIS (THREATS)

Let me start with a question you probably have: how big is this market? I wish I could give you one number. I cannot, and you should be wary of anyone who does. Ken Research, in a report written for a rival's IPO in August 2026, puts India's facade market at ₹9,060 Cr and windows and doors at ₹26,070 Cr, about ₹35,130 Cr together and growing near 11.9% a year . IMARC, which Aluwind quotes in its own annual report, says facades are ₹31,477 Cr and windows and doors ₹65,666 Cr . That is more than three times larger on facades. My guess is that IMARC also counts cladding material, but neither report explains it. I use the smaller Ken figure because its segments look like what Aluwind sells. On that basis, ₹138.6 Cr of revenue is roughly 0.4% of the market.

Now picture who is in the room. Ken counts about 18,000 firms. Only those above ₹30 Cr of revenue count as organised, and they hold 29.9% of facade value, about ₹2,710 Cr, though they are forecast to grow 18.8% a year against 9.1% for the rest . In residential windows about 88% of a ₹20,280 Cr market is unorganised . Think of a tea stall row: a handful of branded cafés and hundreds of carts. Rules about wind loads, fire safety and energy codes push customers toward the cafés, which helps Aluwind. But the carts still set the price for a plain window, and that limits what a mid-sized firm can charge.

Walk through how a job is won. A developer such as Birla Estates or L&T Realty plans a tower. The architect specifies a system, say Eternia's Duranium window. The developer invites a short list of fabricators who passed the pre-qualification test on net worth, experience, capacity, safety record and 'bonding capacity'. Then comes the sentence from the prospectus that I want you to remember: 'price competitiveness of the bid is the most important selection criterion' . So qualification buys a seat at the table, but the lowest acceptable bid, the L1, usually takes the job. Repeat developers sometimes negotiate one-to-

one instead . The mix shows in the customer lists. L&T group entities were about 24% of FY22 revenue and 18% of FY23, then 12% by H1 FY24 as Birla Estates, Gera and Piramal came in . After that the company stopped publishing the lists.

How does Aluwind compare with the people it meets at that table? Fenesta, the DCM Shriram window brand, had ₹856 Cr of FY25 revenue. Alufit made ₹505 Cr at an 11.5% margin but only a 7.2% return on capital. Glass Wall Systems made ₹457 Cr in FY26 at a 23% margin and a 43% return, with net cash and about 45% of sales abroad. Innovators made ₹228 Cr, and Mero Asia, a unit of a German group, ₹253 Cr . Aluwind made ₹138.6 Cr at an 11.8% margin . Its margin is mid-pack. Its return on capital is where the story changes. The company reports 22.2%, but that figure leaves ₹38.7 Cr of short-term borrowings out of capital employed. Put every borrowing in, on the definition Ken Research uses for peers, and I get about 14.5%. That is far below Glass Wall Systems' 43% and just under Innovators' 15.9%.

So what is the moat? I would call it narrow. The strongest piece is the Eternia link: an exclusive fabricator since 2020 and an Anchor Partner for the Mumbai region from December 2023, on a three-year agreement that comes up for renewal in December 2026 . Eternia's own site shows many other fabricator partners . Next is track record: 300 projects across 20 cities and 85 sites running at May 2025 . Then the plant: Pune, with CNC machines and powder coating, where the facade shop is 'close to full utilization' . Last, the balance sheet, where ₹12.65 Cr of deposits sit under bank lien and four family members stand as personal guarantors . Notice what is missing. Nothing here locks a customer in. A developer can award the next tower to someone else at a lower price.

Let me take you to the plant, because the moat lives or dies there. Picture the Pune-Aurangabad highway near Koregaon Bhima, a shed of roughly 100,000 square feet plus a leased 45,000 square feet beside it . Aluminium sections come in, get cut, drilled and routed on CNC machines, and are powder-coated in an in-house line before they leave . A unitised facade unit is glazed in the shed and then lifted onto the tower as a finished panel . In July 2026 the company told the exchange that its facade shop can make up to 20 such panels a day and is 'close to full utilization' . If every panel were the 1.5 m by 4.2 m size used at the L&T Innovation Campus in Powai, that would be about 126 square metres a day, which is my

illustration rather than a disclosed figure . The board has approved a new 40,000 sq ft line for 50 panels a day, costing about ₹20 Cr, funded by banks, and ready in Q1 of FY2027-28 . Until then, the shed is the ceiling on facade growth.

What about pricing power against aluminium? The annual report says contracts are 'fixed price' and the prospectus says they 'usually provide for escalation and delay charges clause' . Gross margin after materials and direct labour was 30.3% in FY25 and 30.0% in FY26, through a volatile aluminium period . That tells me purchasing and contract clauses worked. It does not tell me Aluwind can pass a spike on to a customer who signed a fixed price. Management itself lists raw material volatility first among threats.

Regulation and risk deserve a short word. The energy code of 2017, the Eco-Niwas code of 2024, the National Building Code's wind-load and fire rules and Mumbai's rule for openable glass panels all demand tested, certified systems . That raises the cost of entry for the carts but not for the other cafés. The threats are the ones management lists itself: developers who stretch payments, aluminium swings, a shortage of skilled installers and counterfeit material . The first of those is the epigraph of this chapter, and it is the one I would watch hardest, because it is the one that turns a profitable order into a cash problem.

Three stories from other firms help calibrate. Glass Wall Systems shows the upside: integrated design and fabrication, exports, almost no debt, ROCE of 43% . Durall Systems shows the warning. Its revenue rose 61% in FY25 yet profit fell 71%, margin dropped from 12.8% to 9.6% and debt per rupee of equity went from 0.67 to 0.86 . And Permasteelisa, the firm behind the Sydney Opera House, is a business of about €654M and 1,930 people that Lixil bought for €575M in 2011 and sold to Atlas Holdings in 2020 . Taken together they say: facade contracting rewards track record, punishes growth that outruns the balance sheet, and does not scale like software.

Where does that leave my view? I think the Eternia agreement is more likely renewed than not, perhaps three chances in four, because Hindalco signed a tolling contract with Aluwind in FY26 and the Mumbai relationship is deep . I have not seen the terms, so I hold that number loosely. Even a renewal would not make Aluwind hard to replace. My honest rating of the moat is narrow, with a real but modest edge in Mumbai windows and a thin one in facades.

If you want to test my reading, here is where I would go. Open Aluwind's investor page and the FY26 annual report, read notes 15 to 17 and the cash flow statement, then open the March 2024 prospectus to its working-capital page and compare the two. The Eternia site, a short Eternia video on the partnership, Aluwind's own unitized glazing page and the Wikipedia article on curtain walls will teach you the product. The Ken and IMARC pages cover the market. The links sit in the web edition of this chapter, and the comparison will take you most of an hour. It will also set up the next chapter, where we look at the operating numbers that tell us whether this narrow moat earns cash.

NARRATOR'S REFLECTION

A moat is a reason a customer cannot easily walk away. Aluwind has relationships, a qualified plant and a famous aluminium partner, but a developer can still pick the cheapest bid and Eternia works with other fabricators. Watch two things in the next twelve months: whether the Eternia agreement is renewed in December 2026, and whether new capacity arrives without more bank borrowing.

GLOBAL PARALLEL • INDIA, FY2024 TO FY2026; MUMBAI-BASED INTEGRATED FACADE MAKER • GLASS WALL SYSTEMS (INDIA) LTD (MOAT_SCALING)

Design, fabrication and installation under one roof with 45% of revenue from exports to the US and Australia and almost no debt (debt/equity 0.03 in FY26). Revenue ₹304 Cr (FY24), ₹278 Cr (FY25), ₹457 Cr (FY26); EBITDA margin 18.0%, 26.2%, 23.0%; ROCE 28% to 43%; net debt/equity -0.30 in FY26. Figures come from its own IPO industry report . Same trade, very different economics: a facade firm can earn 23% margins and 43% ROCE when it integrates and exports. Aluwind earns 12% and about 14.5% with borrowed working capital, so the gap is evidence of what its moat is not.

GLOBAL PARALLEL • INDIA, FY2024 TO FY2025; SMALL PREMIUM FACADE AND WINDOW CONTRACTOR • DURALL SYSTEMS INDIA PVT LTD (FAILURE_BASE_RATE)

Revenue growth bought with thinner margins and more debt, so higher billing did not become higher profit. Revenue ₹34.8 Cr to ₹56.0 Cr (+61%); EBITDA margin 12.8% to 9.6%; PAT ₹4.8 Cr to ₹1.4 Cr (-71%); ROCE 15.2% to 6.9%; debt/equity 0.67 to 0.86 . In this trade a faster top line can coincide with falling profit when order size outruns the balance sheet. Aluwind's FY26 revenue rose 27% while operating cash flow stayed negative, which is the early shape of the same pattern.

GLOBAL PARALLEL • ITALY AND GLOBAL, 1973 TO 2025; LANDMARK FACADE CONTRACTOR • PERMASTEELISA GROUP (MOAT_SCALING)

A reputation for engineering hard towers (Sydney Opera House, One World Trade Center) won repeat global work, but each project is custom and scale comes slowly. Revenue €654M in 2025 with 1,930 employees; bought by Lixil for €575M in 2011; sold to Atlas Holdings in 2020 . The best-known facade house in the world is a roughly €650M business that has changed owners twice. Facade contracting rewards track record, not software-style scaling, and Aluwind should be judged on cash per project.

CHAPTER V

Management on Trial — Leading KPIs & Walking the Talk

> *""We remain committed to operational excellence, working capital optimization and executing projects timely.""*
>
> — M.M. KABRA, MANAGING DIRECTOR, FY26 RESULTS PRESS RELEASE, 5 MAY 2026

Imagine you are standing in the finance office of a facade contractor on the day the half-year closes. You could read the profit line. I would rather you looked at six numbers that move before profit does. How big is the order book compared with billing? How full is the plant? What margin does each half-year earn? How much cash is tied up in unfinished work for each rupee of revenue? How concentrated are the customers? And what is the interest bill doing? Aluwind reports only twice a year, so these are half-year readings, and some are not disclosed at all. Revenue, margin, interest, profit, borrowings and cash flow come from the filings. The order book appears in just two press releases, capacity use in one July 2026 filing, and the customer list has not been published since the March 2024 prospectus .

Start with orders, because they are what the plant will build. Management said the order book was about ₹302 Cr in May 2025 and about ₹300 Cr in May 2026 . In between, revenue rose by ₹29.3 Cr. If you add revenue to the change in the book, you get orders won of about ₹137 Cr, which is almost the same as revenue billed. So the company is winning about as much as it builds, a ratio near 1.0, and holds 2.2 years of work. That is a healthy base. But it is the wrong shape for a company that says it will grow 44% next year. A flat order book cannot feed a jump in billing. The half-year filing of November 2026 gave no order book at all .

Margin comes next. Strip out other income, and operating margin was 11.0% in FY25 and 11.8% in FY26. In H1 FY27 it was 13.5% against 12.4% a year earlier on standalone figures (13.4% and 12.3% consolidated), about 110 bps better . That is real progress, and I want to give it credit. Then look beneath the profit line. Other income was ₹2.0 Cr in H1 FY27 against ₹0.3 Cr a year before, and that jump explains 83% of the rise in pre-tax profit. Interest more than doubled to ₹2.25 Cr . So the improvement at the operating level was

partly consumed by the cost of the debt that funds the work, and partly replaced by income that is not from fabrication.

Now the number I care most about. Add inventory, receivables and unbilled work, and subtract what the company owes suppliers. That net trade working capital was about 41% of revenue at March 2024, 55% at March 2025, 64% at March 2026 and 66% at September 2026. Since March 2024, each extra rupee of revenue has needed about one extra rupee of working capital. That figure is approximate, since the FY24 balance sheet does not split unbilled work . Customers also paid less up front: advances fell from ₹9.5 Cr to ₹5.8 Cr in FY26 . Think of a restaurant that must buy the ingredients for the next ten tables before the last ten have paid. Growth makes that restaurant hungrier for cash, not richer.

Two more numbers are simply missing. The company does not split facade from window revenue, and it reports a single segment. In FY26, 98.9% of revenue was windows and facade work and 1.1% was tolling . Management says 'the contribution of facades will increase gradually leading to better execution and margin profiles' . Without a split, you cannot check that. The cleaning subsidiary has no revenue yet and lost ₹0.09 Cr in H1 FY27, and the new solar-facade line has an investment amount of 'depend on market scenario' . I treat all of these as options, not as drivers of FY27.

How much can the plant build? The prospectus put installed capacity at 200,224 square metres a year . Divide the revenue of each earlier period by the output it reported and you get about ₹7,500 per square metre every time, from ₹7,475 to ₹7,586. That is suspiciously steady, and it makes me think the utilisation figures were derived from revenue, not measured on the floor. Use the ₹7,500 anyway. FY26 revenue then needs about 1.85 lakh square metres, or 92% of the prospectus capacity. The ₹200 Cr guidance needs about 2.67 lakh, or 133% of the capacity stated at the March 2024 prospectus and about 102% of the roughly 2.6 lakh square metres rated since the June 2025 CNC addition (Chapter 3). In July 2026 the company said its facade shop makes up to 20 panels a day and is 'close to full utilization'. It approved a ₹20 Cr line for 50 panels a day, bank funded, ready from Q1 of FY2027-28 . To reach ₹200 Cr, H2 FY27 must bill ₹126.0 Cr, 72% more than H2 FY26's ₹73.1 Cr, and 67% of the ₹300 Cr order book must convert within a year.

The market is not the limit. Ken Research sees a ₹35,130 Cr market growing near 11.9% a year, and Aluwind holds about 0.4% . The limits are the shed and the balance sheet. Each ₹60 Cr of extra revenue at 65% working capital needs about ₹39 Cr of funding, while a year of profit is about ₹11 Cr. About ₹28 Cr would come from banks, or about ₹49 Cr if working capital keeps absorbing a rupee for every extra rupee of sales, as it did from FY24 to FY26. Those are my calculations, not company figures. I give FY27 revenue of ₹200 Cr a chance of 10% or less. My likely range is ₹150 Cr to ₹170 Cr, with about 70% confidence.

Now to the part you may find most useful: did management do what it said? I gave myself a simple rule. Take the promise, find the next filing that tests it, and score it delivered, partly, missed or too early. First, the IPO money. The prospectus asked for ₹20.45 Cr for working capital and ₹6.50 Cr for general purposes. The company used ₹20.45 Cr, ₹6.55 Cr and ₹2.70 Cr of issue costs, all by 30 September 2025, and an auditor's certificate of November 2025 reports no deviation . Delivered.

Second, the working capital plan. In the prospectus the company said it would 'usually bill and collect on relatively short cycles', and planned for FY26 an inventory of ₹21.5 Cr, payables of ₹8.7 Cr and short-term borrowings of just ₹7.8 Cr . At March 2026 inventory was ₹57.6 Cr, about 207 days of materials consumed (167 on the company's own ratio basis), payables ₹40.1 Cr and borrowings ₹41.3 Cr. Only receivable days beat the plan, at 103 against 114 . That is a miss, and not a small one. Inventory was 2.7 times the plan, and the company leaned on suppliers and banks for the difference.

Third, modernisation and expansion. The prospectus said the plant 'operates on semi automation' and the company would modernise. The FY25 report promised 'facility modernization and capacity enhancement' . The company bought a 5-axis CNC machine and an automated powder-coating line, spent ₹4.5 Cr on assets in FY26 and took a ₹2.45 Cr machinery loan . It named Chennai and Madurai projects, but not revenue from Karnataka, Gujarat or Telangana . Partly delivered. Fourth, the FY27 target. The press release said the company was 'confident of achieving its guided turnover target of ₹200 crore for FY27, driven by improved execution and margin expansion' . Margin has improved about 110 bps and revenue is up 13% in H1, but the plant and book arithmetic above is against it. Too early, and stretched.

Fifth, exports and partnerships. The FY25 report spoke of exploring exports and building partnerships to raise capacity use . The tolling contract with Hindalco added ₹1.57 Cr in FY26, 1.1% of revenue, and foreign exchange earned was nil in both years . On 5 November 2026 the company hired Ajay Porwal as President, Global Business 'to explore the possibility of expanding its business activities into the export market' . Tolling delivered, exports too early.

Finally, the sentence at the top of this chapter. The Managing Director said, 'We remain committed to operational excellence, working capital optimization and executing projects timely' . Hold it against the cash flow statement. FY26 operating cash flow was -₹16.3 Cr, inventory absorbed ₹27.0 Cr and working capital as a whole ₹30.0 Cr . H1 FY27 turned to + ₹0.8 Cr: inventory released ₹6.2 Cr, but receivables rose ₹10.3 Cr and payables fell ₹3.5 Cr . One improvement, two reversals. My score is partly, and too early to say more. The CFO, the company secretary and an independent director all changed between May and September 2026 . I would not read that as trouble. I would read it as a company whose finance team is new just when the working capital questions get hard.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
>
> Management keeps the promises it can keep alone: it spent the IPO money as stated and bought machines. It misses the ones that need customers and suppliers to cooperate, and those are the promises that make cash. Trust the next filings, not the guidance: operating cash flow above profit for two halves in a row would tell you more than another order book headline.

CHAPTER VI

Following the Cash — 10-Year Financials & Earnings Quality

> *"“Sustained negative cash flow could impact our growth and business.”"*
>
> — ALUWIND ARCHITECTURAL LTD., PROSPECTUS DATED 20 MARCH 2024, RISK FACTOR 17

Let me be upfront about what I could not give you. A ten-year record of Aluwind does not exist in public. The company listed in April 2024, so I had to stitch the history from the March 2024 prospectus, which restates FY21 to FY23 and the first half of FY24, then the FY24, FY25 and FY26 annual reports and the half-year results up to September 2026 . That gives us six full years and one half. It is shorter than I would like, but it covers the small-company years, the listing and two years of real growth, and that is enough to see the pattern.

Start with the part that looks wonderful. Revenue rose from ₹21.3 Cr in FY21 to ₹138.6 Cr in FY26, about 6.5 times, roughly 45% a year. Profit after tax went from ₹0.77 Cr to ₹10.45 Cr. Operating margin, before other income, climbed from 6% in FY22 to 14% in FY24 and has stayed between 11% and 14% since . If you stopped reading here you would think you had found a small compounder. Per share, though, the picture is flatter. Profit rose 38.5% from FY24 to FY26, but earnings per share rose only 1.7%, because the IPO added 66 lakh shares to a base of 1.82 Cr . The share count has been 2,48,47,420 since April 2024, and 90,000 options were granted in January 2026 .

Now the part that should slow you down. Look at the cash. In FY24 the business made ₹7.5 Cr of profit and had an operating cash outflow of ₹2.3 Cr. In FY25, profit was ₹8.1 Cr and operating cash flow -₹18.9 Cr. In FY26, profit was ₹10.45 Cr and operating cash flow -₹16.3 Cr. Over FY24 to FY26 the company reported ₹26.1 Cr of profit and burned ₹37.5 Cr from operations . The prospectus told us this could happen: 'Sustained negative cash flow could impact our growth and business' . It was a risk factor in March 2024. By November 2026 it is a three-year record.

Where did the money go? Picture a facade order from start to cash. Aluminium sections and glass come into the Pune shed first. The company pays suppliers, but suppliers give credit, so part of that is borrowed from them. The units are cut, coated and assembled, so the cost sits in inventory and work in progress. The company recognises revenue as the work progresses, which is the accounting rule for contracts, so profit appears before the invoice does. That is the unbilled work. When the invoice goes out, the customer withholds a slice, the retention, until the defect liability period ends. Only then does cash arrive. At March 2026 each stage was bigger than a year before. Inventory was ₹57.6 Cr, up from ₹30.5 Cr, with raw material up from ₹17.4 Cr to ₹30.6 Cr and stores and spares from ₹5.1 Cr to ₹13.8 Cr. Unbilled work was ₹32.8 Cr. Retention held by customers was ₹13.7 Cr. And customers' advances, which fund work upfront, fell from ₹9.5 Cr to ₹5.8 Cr . Add unbilled work and retention and you get ₹46.4 Cr, which is 4.4 times the year's profit: income that was booked but not yet collected.

In FY26, operating profit before working capital was ₹16.9 Cr. Inventory then took ₹27.0 Cr, receivables and unbilled work took ₹16.1 Cr, and supplier credit gave back ₹14.4 Cr. After ₹3.2 Cr of tax, operating cash flow was -₹16.3 Cr. FY25 looked the same: ₹12.6 Cr before working capital, ₹28.0 Cr absorbed by it, -₹18.9 Cr in the end . Notice that the receivables are not rotten. About 92% of non-retention debtors are under six months old, and bad-debt expense was ₹0.05 Cr . This is a capital need, not an accounting fraud. But a capital need is still a bill, and someone has to pay it.

Who paid? In FY25 it was the IPO. The company raised ₹27.0 Cr net in April 2024, ₹29.70 Cr gross. In FY26 it was the banks. Borrowings went from ₹13.1 Cr to ₹41.3 Cr over the year and to ₹46.0 Cr by September 2026 . Over FY25 and FY26 the company took in ₹52.5 Cr of financing. Operations ate ₹35.2 Cr. Investing took ₹16.1 Cr, of which ₹6.0 Cr was machines and ₹12.1 Cr went into deposits under bank lien, gold and property . The lines are not cheap: cash credit from ICICI and Kotak at 8.15%, a ₹10 Cr working-capital loan, and ₹9.1 Cr of unsecured bank and NBFC loans at 8.15% to 13.5% that can be called on demand, with four family members as personal guarantors . Interest went from ₹1.20 Cr in FY25 to ₹2.16 Cr in FY26, and ₹2.25 Cr in H1 FY27 alone. Operating profit covered the interest 9.1 times in FY25, 6.8 times in FY26 and 4.0 times in H1 FY27, by my arithmetic.

What does that do to returns? Return on equity slipped from 19.3% to 16.1%. Break it into three pieces: margin on sales, how hard the assets work, and how much borrowed money sits on top. In FY25 that was 7.44% × 1.28 × 2.03. In FY26 it was 7.54% × 1.02 × 2.09. The margin did not move. The assets worked less hard, because they grew faster than revenue, which is the working capital again. Leverage looks flat only because IPO equity was there to dilute the new debt. The company reports a return on capital of 22.2%, but it leaves ₹38.7 Cr of short-term borrowings out of capital employed. On the definition Ken Research uses for peers, I get about 14.5% . At the margin it is thinner. From FY24 to FY26, operating profit before interest and tax rose ₹3.8 Cr, while capital rose ₹74 Cr. That is a pre-tax return near 5%, or about 6.5% on operating capital alone, below the 8.15% to 13.5% the company pays its lenders .

Let me clear the other forensic items quickly. Related-party dealings are tiny: directors' pay of ₹1.08 Cr, two directors' sons earning ₹0.11 Cr and ₹0.13 Cr, a promoter loan repaid, and ₹0.06 Cr to the subsidiary's managing director . Contingent liabilities are ₹1.20 Cr of tax and GST disputes. The FY26 notes do not quantify outstanding bank guarantees; at September 2023 guarantees and letters of credit were ₹9.34 Cr, and today ₹7.5 Cr of payables are backed by letters of credit and ₹12.65 Cr of deposits sit under lien . The auditor, R Kejriwal & Co of Surat, gave an unmodified opinion, no key audit matters, no default and no diversion of IPO money, for a fee printed as ₹2 lakh . I would still ask three questions: how the auditor's 'no' on short-term funds financing long-term uses sits beside ₹9.7 Cr of long-term deposits; what the 'corrections of prior period errors' in the H1 FY27 note were; and why FY25 operating cash flow appears as -₹18.85 Cr in one filing and -₹18.32 Cr in another .

Other income was 11.8% of pre-tax profit in FY25 and 11.0% in FY26. In FY26 it was interest of ₹0.42 Cr, rebate and settlement of ₹0.55 Cr and capital gains of ₹0.57 Cr. In H1 FY27 it was 22.6% of pre-tax profit and the filing does not itemise it . Tax has run at about 25% to 26%. Promoters held 72.13% through September 2025, 72.15% in March 2026 and 72.61% in September 2026, and a domestic institution appears at 1.17% . The IPO money did what it promised: ₹20.45 Cr to working capital, ₹6.55 Cr to general purposes, ₹2.70 Cr to issue costs, all used by September 2025 with no deviation . Yet working capital absorbed

₹28.0 Cr in FY25 and ₹30.0 Cr in FY26, so the proceeds covered less than a year of the need.

So what changed in the latest half-year? Operating cash flow was +₹0.81 Cr on profit of ₹6.6 Cr. Inventory released ₹6.2 Cr. But receivables, net of unbilled work being invoiced, rose ₹10.3 Cr, and suppliers were paid down by ₹3.5 Cr. Free cash flow was still -₹0.9 Cr before ₹2.3 Cr of interest, and borrowings rose to ₹46.0 Cr . Look at the balance sheet too. Trade receivables went from ₹39.1 Cr to ₹54.7 Cr in six months, while inventory fell from ₹57.6 Cr to ₹51.4 Cr and payables from ₹40.1 Cr to ₹36.6 Cr. Equity reached ₹76.8 Cr and cash ₹4.8 Cr. In plain words, the shed is emptying a little, the customers are paying more slowly, and the company is paying its own suppliers faster. After two years of burning cash, break-even is a better sign. It is not yet a cure.

Now the judgment you asked me to make. Is the gap timing or structural? I say 60% to 65% structural and 35% to 40% timing. It is structural because working capital has been 39% to 54% of revenue since FY21, so this has always been a capital-hungry trade, and larger facade orders may carry more unbilled work, though the mix is not disclosed. It is timing because ₹300 Cr of orders, the H1 inventory release and new capacity from FY28 can all pull the ratio down. In numbers: I give 55% to FY27 operating cash flow being positive, 25% to it reaching half of profit, and 55% to borrowings above ₹50 Cr at March 2027. If net working capital falls below 55% of revenue, or cash flow beats profit in a half-year, I will move my view, and I will tell you.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
>
> Profit that has not turned into cash is a loan you have made to your customers. For two years Aluwind's shareholders and banks have made that loan on its behalf: ₹26.1 Cr of profit, ₹37.5 Cr of cash burned, debt tripled. The receivables are good, and the audit is clean. The test now is simple: show cash above profit in a single half-year, and the story changes.

CHAPTER VII

Why the Stock Trades Here — Market Expectations vs. Peers

> *""Price is what you pay. Value is what you get.""*
>
> — WARREN BUFFETT, BERKSHIRE HATHAWAY 2008 SHAREHOLDER LETTER

Let us start with the number everyone looks at first. On the last close you could buy a share of Aluwind for ₹44.90, which values the whole company at about ₹110.6 Cr. That is roughly nine times the profit of the last twelve months, and about one and a half times the book value the accounts show. If you had bought at the IPO in April 2024 you would have paid ₹45. You would own the same price today, in a company whose revenue has grown from ₹83 Cr to ₹138 Cr in the audited year and ₹147 Cr over the last twelve months .

How can that be? Look at the path rather than the end points. By October 2025 the stock had closed near ₹91, almost double its IPO price, after a run of order announcements from Larsen and Toubro, Godrej and others. Since then it has fallen about 51%, and the 52-week range is ₹40 to ₹85. During that fall nothing broke in the profit and loss account. FY26 was a good year on that statement. What the market read, and I think read correctly, was the cash-flow statement and the borrowing line .

Here is the part that surprises people. A cheap multiple is not the same as a cheap business. Think of enterprise value as the price of the whole house, including the mortgage, not just your share of the equity. Aluwind has ₹46.06 Cr of borrowings, ₹4.80 Cr of cash and ₹14.25 Cr of investments that are mostly deposits pledged to banks, plus some gold and property. Net those off and the debt is about ₹27 Cr, so the whole business is priced at about ₹138 Cr, or 7.5 times trailing operating profit before other income. That is cheap for a growing contractor. It is also the price of a company that needs its lenders .

So let me ask the question a reverse DCF asks. We usually forecast and then arrive at a value. Here I want to start with the price and ask what you have to believe. If the owners could take home every rupee of profit as free cash, the price would need only about 6% annual growth for five years at a 17% required return, which is a sensible hurdle for a small, thinly traded stock. If they can take home 80%, you need about 12% growth. If they can take home 60%,

you need about 20%. If they can take home 40%, which is closer to the last three years, you need more than 30% a year, and nobody should pay for that .

Do you see where this goes? The multiple is not the argument. Conversion is. Over FY24 to FY26 the company earned ₹26 Cr and its operations absorbed ₹37.5 Cr, with banks and the IPO filling the gap. In the first half of FY27, operations finally returned a small positive ₹0.8 Cr. One half-year is a hopeful sign, not a pattern. A buyer at today's price is making a bet that the receivables, the retention money and the unbilled revenue shrink back toward a normal share of sales. That is possible. It has not yet been shown .

What do other listed companies tell us? I could not find a clean twin, so I looked at four. Innovators Facade Systems is the closest facade contractor. It trades at a trailing P/E of 12.4 and 1.15 times book value, on 47% trailing revenue growth. Glass Wall Systems listed in September 2026 and sits at 6.2 times book value and a P/E of 25, because it earns a 23% operating margin and a 43% return on capital, holds net cash and exports. Ahluwalia Contracts is at 15.7 times and Capacit'e at 8.0 times, and the gap between those two is at least consistent with a working-capital story .

That last name deserves a pause, because it is the closest thing to a warning label. Capacit'e is a Mumbai contractor that kept reporting profit while its net working capital cycle grew from about 25% of revenue in FY19 to about 40% in FY23. Bank limits ran at nearly 98% use. The credit rating slid from A to D in August 2021, on the day the stock dropped almost 17% to ₹165, and the company raised ₹96 Cr of equity in 2023. On my measure Aluwind's working capital has climbed from about 41% to about 66% of sales, and the funding is short-term bank lines. The two measures are not identical. I am not predicting the same ending. It is one case, not a statistical base rate, and the scale, client mix and balance sheet differ a great deal: Capacit'e had FY23 revenue of about ₹1,791 Cr, and it now trades at 8.0 times earnings. It shows what stretched cash can do to ratings and equity when collections slip .

So what is the market doing? It pays about nine times for reported profit, a fair price for a small contractor. It charges a discount because the shares barely trade: roughly ₹4.3 lakh changes hands on an average day. And it charges for the cash that has not shown up. If conversion improves, the multiple can move without any change in the profit line. If it does not, the price needs the heroic growth in the grid above .

Here is how I frame the next two years. In the bear case, revenue reaches only ₹155 Cr, margins slip to 11%, interest cost rises and profit falls to about ₹6.8 Cr. At ten times that, the stock is worth about ₹27, roughly 0.8 times book value. In the base case revenue reaches ₹190 Cr at a 12.5% margin, profit is about ₹12.6 Cr, and at eleven times the stock is worth about ₹56. In the bull case, revenue reaches ₹215 Cr at 13.5%, profit is about ₹16 Cr and at thirteen times the stock is worth about ₹84. These are my estimates, not the company's .

The base case is sober on profit but generous on the multiple. Profit of ₹12.6 Cr is only a little above today's ₹12.1 Cr, because I expect interest and depreciation to absorb most of the margin gain on a larger balance sheet. About 80% of the base case's gain is the multiple moving from nine times to eleven, and at nine times the same profit is worth about ₹47. It also needs about ₹91 Cr of revenue in the second half of FY27, 24% above last year's second half, with the order book flat at about ₹300 Cr. I do not rate the ₹200 Cr FY27 target as likely, for the reasons in Chapter 5. You can disagree with me. If you do, the arithmetic above lets you swap your own revenue and margin into the same formula and see how far the answer moves.

Let me walk through the reverse DCF slowly, because the idea is simpler than the name. Imagine you owned the whole company. Today it earns about ₹12.1 Cr after tax. If every rupee of that could be taken out and spent, and the profit grew for five years and then 5% a year forever, what growth would make the present value equal the ₹110.6 Cr the market asks? At a 17% required return, the answer is about 6%. Now imagine only 60 paise of each rupee is free to take out, because 40 paise must stay in the business to fund bigger inventories and slower customers. Then the profit has to grow about 20% a year to justify the same price. The business did not change. Only the conversion did .

The 17% deserves a word. I use it because this is a small, thinly traded stock listed on an SME platform, where an investor may wait days to sell. A large, liquid company might deserve 12% or 13%. At 15% the grid is a little kinder and at 20% it is harsher, and I show all three so that you can pick your own. What I will not do is pretend that one number is right. The point of the exercise is to see how steeply the required growth rises as conversion falls.

Think about what a rupee of extra sales costs this company. On my numbers, net trade working capital, which is inventory plus bills owed to the company plus unbilled work, less

what it owes suppliers, rose by about ₹55 Cr between March 2024 and March 2026 while revenue rose by about ₹55 Cr. That is close to one rupee of working capital for every extra rupee of sales. If that ratio persists, every rupee of growth the order book promises is financed by lenders, and the equity holders see the profit but not the cash .

So where does this leave you? The price looks reasonable if you believe cash will follow profit, and demanding if you do not. The next chapter looks at what the tape is saying about who is buying and selling, because on a stock this thinly traded the chart can mislead as easily as it can inform.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
>
> A multiple is a fraction, and the denominator here is profit that has not yet turned into cash. If you only remember one thing from this chapter, remember that the same nine-times P/E means two very different things depending on whether conversion is 40% or 80%.

GLOBAL PARALLEL • INDIA, MUMBAI METROPOLITAN REGION, FY2019 TO FY2023; BUILDING CONTRACTOR FOR DEVELOPERS AND PUBLIC CLIENTS • CAPACIT'E INFRAPROJECTS LTD (SINGLE-CASE ANALOGUE) (FAILURE_BASE_RATE)

Capacit'e is a listed Mumbai contractor whose profit stayed positive while its net working capital stretched. Ind-Ra put the net working capital cycle at 24.8% of revenue in FY19 and 40.3% in FY23. A Mumbai-concentrated order book, slow-paying clients and retention money absorbed the cash, bank limits ran at about 98% use, and the rating moved from IND A with a negative outlook in June 2020 to IND D in August 2021 after delays in servicing debt, then to IND BB+ in February 2023. The shares fell 16.58% to ₹165.25 on the August 2021 downgrade day. Ind-Ra later recorded unbilled revenue of ₹930 Cr in FY23 against ₹570 Cr in FY22, and the company raised ₹96.3 Cr of equity in July 2023 to repair liquidity. On our measure, Aluwind's net trade working capital rose from about 41% of revenue in FY24 to about 66% of trailing revenue at September 2026. That definition is not identical to Ind-Ra's, but the direction and the funding (short-term bank lines) rhyme. This is one case, not a statistical base rate, and the differences are large: Capacit'e had FY23 revenue of about ₹1,791 Cr against Aluwind's ₹139 Cr, a large public-sector client in CIDCO and a Mumbai-concentrated order book, and it now trades at 8.0 times earnings on a Stage 1 base in the peer table above. The analogue shows what a stretched cash cycle can do to ratings, equity and the share price when collections slip; it does not say Aluwind will follow. Watch bank-limit use, retention money and any equity raise .

CHAPTER VIII

Reading the Tape — Trend, Volume & Momentum Opportunity

> *""Below 30-week SMA (48.54) and 50-day SMA (46.67) with weak trend structure. Technical ceiling: avoid for new entries until a Stage 1 base and Stage 2 breakout form.""*
>
> — DESK STAGE 2 SNAPSHOT FOR NSE:ALUWIND, 13 NOVEMBER 2026 CLOSE

Let us look at the chart together, the way you would look at a house before you ask about the price. I use Stan Weinstein's four stages because they stop me from arguing with the trend. Stage 1 is the base after a decline. Stage 2 is the uptrend above a rising 30-week average. Stage 3 is the top. Stage 4 is the decline below a falling 30-week average. Aluwind closed at ₹44.90. The 30-week average sits at ₹48.54 and the 200-day average at ₹52.86, and both are falling. That is Stage 4, and our deterministic snapshot says so in plain terms: avoid new entries until a base and a breakout form .

Now compare the stock with its surroundings. On the same day our ledger called the Nifty 50 an uptrend, with 80% of the large stocks above their 50-day averages. Aluwind is down 46.6% over twelve months and sits 47% below its 52-week high of ₹85 while the index climbed. When a stock falls in a rising market it is telling you the cause is its own: here, the cash that did not arrive, the borrowing that did, and a float so thin that few buyers were waiting .

I should be honest about one limitation. The Stage 2 scanner we use only covers companies worth at least ₹1,000 Cr, and Aluwind is worth about ₹110 Cr. So the fact that the stock is not on that list tells you nothing. My Stage 4 call rests on the price and its averages, which the snapshot reads directly .

What do the three time frames say? On the weekly chart the RSI, a gauge where 30 is oversold and 70 is overbought, reads 41, which fits a downtrend. On the daily chart it reads 50, neutral. On the four-hour chart it reads 53, and the price has just climbed back above its four-hour 20-period average at ₹44.04 but not above the 50-period average at ₹45.36. The tool calls this a dislocation at a major shelf. In English: a stock that has fallen to a floor near ₹40, with a small intraday turn. I would call that a pause, not a reversal .

Volume is where I get cautious. The last session traded 3,000 shares. The ten-day average is 12,300 and the thirty-day average is 9,650, so the last session ran at under a third of the usual pace. At today's price, an average day is about ₹4.3 lakh of trading. Only about 65 lakh shares are in public hands, and 0.15% of them changes hands daily. Picture a hall with a few buyers and a few sellers. One large order can move the price and draw a candle that means nothing. For a breakout to count here I want to see volume at least twice the average and a weekly close above the 30-week line .

Who owns the stock? Promoters hold 72.61% after a small increase from 72.15% in March, so the insiders are not selling. Institutions show up for the first time at 1.17%. There are only 945 shareholders, down from 987 a year earlier. None of this tells me anyone is accumulating. It tells me the stock is closely held and thinly traded, which is exactly why a chart on this name should be read lightly .

So is there a trade? I do not see one. The structure is Stage 4, relative strength is poor, volume is dry, and a normal day's range is ₹1.82, or 4.1% of the price. A tight stop will be hit by noise. A swing trader would wait. A bargain hunter might try the ₹40 floor, but on 9,650 shares a day the exit is as hard as the entry, and I do not recommend it as a trade.

You will notice my levels differ from the snapshot's. The tool shows a support zone from ₹43.74 to ₹45.08 and a stop at ₹43.50, which is less than one ATR below the price. In a stock this thin that stop is inside the daily noise. I prefer the structural shelves: an accumulation zone from ₹40.00 to ₹42.00, with the 52-week low and the ₹39.65 pivot at the bottom and the last three weekly lows, between ₹41 and ₹42, at the top, and an invalidation at a weekly close below ₹36.95. That stop is about four and a half ATRs from here and 12% below the top of my zone. At the top of the zone the base value pays 2.8 for every 1 at risk; at the bottom it pays 5.3 .

Size is the last question, and liquidity answers it before volatility does. A 2% position in a ₹42.9 lakh portfolio is about ₹86,000, or 1,900 shares. That is a fifth of an average day's volume. In a falling market you might need several days to get out. So I treat anything above roughly 1,000 shares as a liquidity problem, whatever the risk table says.

Let me show you how I would read the weekly chart if you and I were sitting at the same screen. Over the last year the month-end closes drifted from the mid-₹70s to ₹42.3 in October 2026, with lower highs most of the way. That is the signature of a Stage 4 decline: each rally fails a little lower. In the two most recent weekly bars the stock traded about 69,000 and then 51,000 shares as it climbed from the ₹42 area back to the mid-₹40s, busy by this stock's standards. A bounce on a bit more volume is what a floor looks like at its earliest. It is also what any random bounce looks like, which is why I ask for a weekly close above the 30-week average before I change my mind .

Why does the 30-week average matter more than any single day's move? It averages about seven months of closes, so it filters out the noise of thin trading. When the price is under it and it is falling, as it is now, sellers have been in control for most of the year. When the price closes a week above it and the line turns up, the balance of power has changed. On a stock that trades 9,650 shares a day, I do not trust any shorter signal. The cost of waiting for the longer one is that you buy higher. I accept that cost, because the other mistake, buying a falling stock whose cash flow is still negative, is more expensive.

Where does that leave the trade? The structure says wait, and the numbers say the wait could be short, because the ₹40 to ₹42 zone is only 6% to 11% below the last close. The chapter after this one puts the business, the price and the tape on one scale, and tells you what I would do and what I would need to see.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
>
> A chart on a thinly traded stock is a rumor about supply and demand, not a measurement. Use it to avoid fighting a falling trend, and use the business facts to decide whether the floor is worth owning.

CHAPTER IX

Bull vs. Bear, Likely Outcomes & Our Action Plan

> *""“The margin of safety is always dependent on the price paid.”"*
>
> — BENJAMIN GRAHAM, THE INTELLIGENT INVESTOR, CHAPTER 20

Let me tell you where I land, and then let us earn it. For new money, my call is wait: an accumulation zone of ₹40.00 to ₹42.00, an invalidation at a weekly close below ₹36.95, and a base value of ₹56. For the business itself, my verdict from the first six chapters is cyclical and conditional. It is a genuine, audited facade contractor whose profit is real and whose cash conversion is not proven. The chart is in Stage 4. Put those together and you get a business worth studying that you do not chase, at a price that does not yet pay you for the open question.

Let us give the optimist the floor first, as strongly as an optimist would. The company says it has about ₹300 Cr of orders in hand, 2.2 times last year's revenue. The orders have names you know: Runwal at ₹90 Cr, Godrej Reserve at ₹43 Cr, a Capgemini campus at ₹43 Cr, the Innovation Campus at ₹24 Cr. In the half-year to September, the operating margin rose to about 13.4% and consolidated profit grew about 31% to ₹6.6 Cr. The facade shop is almost full, and a ₹20 Cr extension for 50 more panels a day is planned from the first quarter of FY28 .

The optimist can also point to housekeeping that is improving. The IPO money was used exactly as promised. The auditor gave a clean opinion. In the first half of FY27, operations produced a small positive cash flow, and inventory dropped by about ₹6 Cr. Shareholders raised the borrowing limit to ₹200 Cr with every vote cast in favour, which gives the company room to take larger jobs. At nine times earnings and one and a half times book, the stock is priced below Ahluwalia at 15.7 times and well below the new listing Glass Wall Systems at 25 times. If cash catches up with profit, the whole upside case is a re-rating .

Now the pessimist, with the same courtesy. Over three years the company earned ₹26 Cr and its operations absorbed ₹37.5 Cr. Working capital grew from 41% of sales to about 66%. Borrowings rose from ₹13 Cr to ₹46 Cr in a year and a half. Operating profit covered

interest nine times in FY25 and only about four times in the latest half. The prospectus promised 72 days of inventory and 27 to 29 days of payables. FY26 delivered about 207 days and 144 days by my count, or 167 and 118 on the company's own ratio basis, both far from the plan. That is a plan missed, not a plan delayed .

Then the guidance. The company wants ₹200 Cr of revenue in FY27. It has done ₹74 Cr in the first half, so the second half must deliver ₹126 Cr, 72% above last year's second half, while the facade capacity is near full until the middle of FY28. My probability that it hits the full number is 10% or less. A good part of the first-half profit gain came from other income, about 83% of the rise in pre-tax profit, and the filing does not itemise it. The company secretary, the CFO and an independent director all left within five months, and a new global-business president joined in November .

One more worry belongs on the table, because it is easy to miss. The Eternia anchor agreement, which makes Aluwind a preferred fabricator in the Mumbai region, expires in December 2026. Projects tied to Eternia were 52% of revenue in the first half of FY24. Nobody has announced non-renewal, and I assume renewal is likely. But the terms matter, and the company has not disclosed them. Chapter 7's Capacit'e story shows what happens when stretched cash meets a moment of stress .

How do I weigh the two cases? I give 35% to a bear year in which revenue reaches only ₹155 Cr and the stock is worth about ₹27. I give 45% to a base year of ₹190 Cr revenue and a stock near ₹56. I give 20% to a bull year of ₹215 Cr and about ₹84. The weighted value is about ₹51, which is 14% above the last close. That is roughly 9% a year for a stock where the bear case costs you 39% and where a large exit could take days. It does not pay me for the risk at ₹44.90.

Now look at the same trade through a stop. At ₹44.90, with a stop at ₹36.95 below the structural floor, the base value gives you 1.4 rupees of gain for every rupee at risk. My hurdle is 1.5. If you can buy at ₹42.00, it becomes 2.8 to 1, and lower it only improves. Against a 17% hurdle on the weighted value of ₹51, the break-even entry is about ₹40.50, so only entries near ₹40.50 or lower clear it, and above ₹41, or before the second-half results, I would buy no more than a third of my size cap. That is why my answer is a wait with a price and not a refusal. If the business were failing, I would reject it outright. It is not failing.

Margins and audit quality are intact, and the evidence that settles the question will arrive within six months.

What are those pieces of evidence? First, whether Eternia renews in December. Second, the full-year results in about May 2027, which should show at least ₹5 Cr of operating cash flow in the second half, borrowings still below ₹60 Cr, and FY27 revenue near ₹165 Cr. Third, over the long run, whether the return on added capital rises above the 8% to 13.5% that the company pays its lenders, and whether the working capital falls toward half of sales. Those three tests cover the short, medium and long horizons, and today none of them is passed. I label the KPIs pass-with-watch and not fail because margins, orders and audit quality hold and the last half-year's cash flow turned positive; a second weak half would change that .

What about money you already own? The positions ledger shows no Aluwind shares, so there is nothing to sell, and the holding action is simply not held. If you do buy later, size it by liquidity first. About 1,000 shares, or ₹45,000, is the most I would hold, and no more than a third of that before the second-half results, because the stock's own trading volume is the binding constraint. Everything here is an advisory alert, not a broker order .

Let me test my own call by asking how it could be wrong. The most likely error is that I wait, the Eternia agreement is renewed, a good order arrives, and the stock jumps 20% in a week on thin volume. I would miss about ₹9 a share, roughly the gap between ₹44.90 and ₹54. I accept that risk. A stock that trades 9,650 shares a day can gap past any limit order, and chasing it would break my own rule about entry. The cost of being early to a mistake is usually larger than the cost of being late to a right call.

The other error is that the price drops through ₹40 before any good news, and I conclude the market knows something I do not. That is why the invalidation sits at a weekly close below ₹36.95 and not at a casual dip, and why I will re-underwrite rather than average down. The Capacit'e story from Chapter 7 reminds me that stretched cash cycles often end with an equity raise at a discount. If Aluwind announces one, I will treat it as new information about the base case, not as a bargain.

Two sensitivities help you check my arithmetic with your own numbers. First, each ₹1 Cr of profit is worth about ₹0.40 of earnings per share, because there are 2.48 crore shares, so at

eleven times earnings each extra crore of profit is worth about ₹4.4 a share. Second, each five points of revenue tied up in working capital is about ₹8 Cr on ₹165 Cr of sales, which is around 7% of the whole market value. The cash cycle is worth more to the shareholder than the margin debate, which is why I keep returning to it.

And where should the next unit of cash go while Aluwind waits? I put all of it in cash. Two shortlist names, Ajmera Realty at 4.6 to 1 and Manorama Industries at 2.1 to 1, pass the technical gate in the 13 November snapshot. But the 12 November ledger had Ajmera in Stage 3, both sit just above the top of their own entry zones, Manorama fell 5.5% in a day that I have not reviewed, and Ajmera is already 4% of the portfolio in a real-estate name. I would rather wait for a fresh snapshot than fund a name on a conflicting reading. Aluwind gets 0%, with a price and a set of events that would change my mind. One caution on the numbers: my 1.4 to 1 for Aluwind is measured to my own ₹36.95 stop, while the shortlist ratios use the snapshot's closer stops, so they are not strictly comparable.

Current holding decision: NOT HELD. NOT HELD (0 shares); no current holding to trim or exit.. The same-session positions ledger (12 November 2026) shows no ALUWIND shares in any account, so there is nothing to hold, trim or exit. Any future entry should be sized to liquidity first: about 1,000 shares or ₹45,000 at most, and no more than one third of that before the H2 FY27 results, because the stock averages roughly 9,650 shares a day. These are advisory alerts, not broker orders. Alert plan: Price trades inside ₹40.00–₹42.00 and the ₹40 shelf holds on a weekly close — Review for a staged starter of at most one third of the 1,000-share cap (about 330 shares), and only after the Eternia renewal is confirmed and the latest cash-flow evidence is not negative; no shares are sold because none are held.; Weekly close above the 30-week SMA of ₹48.54 with volume at least twice the 30-day average (about 19,300 shares a day) — Re-underwrite for ACCUMULATE_ON_DIP as a Stage 2 breakout, provided cash-flow evidence has not worsened.; Weekly close below the invalidation level — Cancel any pending entry plan and re-underwrite before reconsidering; no shares are held.; Eternia anchor-partner agreement due for renewal in December 2026 — Read the renewal terms; non-renewal or a narrowed territory turns the call to REJECTED on the next review.; H2 FY27 results and cash-flow statement (about May 2027) — Recheck operating cash flow (at least ₹5 Cr for the half), borrowings (below ₹60 Cr), FY27 revenue near ₹165 Cr and net trade working capital. Capital redeployment: 0.00% to AJMERA (SHORTLIST): No

allocation today; AJMERA stays the best-ranked shortlist candidate to revisit.; Fund only on a pullback into its zone of ₹124.51–₹132.17 with Stage 2 confirmed in a fresh snapshot.; 0.00% to MANORAMA (SHORTLIST): No allocation today.; Fund only inside ₹1,869.54–₹1,957.58 after a fresh verification of the one-day fall and the stage reading.; 0.00% to ALUWIND (OUTSIDE): No allocation to ALUWIND now; it stays the researched outside candidate.; Only inside ₹40.00–₹42.00 (or after a weekly close above ₹48.54 on twice average volume) with the ₹36.95 weekly-close invalidation, after the Eternia renewal is confirmed; one third of the 1,000-share cap until the H2 FY27 results.; 100.00% to CASH (CASH): Hold the entire marginal cash unit in cash.; Deploy when a current equity setup clears the evidence, technical and 1.5:1 reward-to-risk gates in a fresh same-session snapshot.

Options and Call-Convexity Playbook (NOT OPTIONABLE OR ILLIQUID): ALUWIND has no liquid listed options chain (not in NSE F&O segment) — express any thesis strictly via cash equity.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
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> A wait is a decision. It says the business is worth owning at one price and not at another, and it names the evidence that would move the price. If the evidence arrives and the price is still there, you buy with a plan. If it does not, you have saved yourself the lesson.

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